# ENR 1.2 VISUAL FLIGHT RULES

**1 Visibility and distance from cloud.**

Every VFR flight shall be so conducted that the aircraft is flown with visual reference to the surface by day and to identifiable objects by night and at no time above more than three eighths of cloud within a radius of 5NM of such aircraft and -

a) in the case of aircraft excluding helicopters operating under conditions of visibility and distance from cloud equal to, or greater than, the conditions specified in table 1 and 2:

Table 1

| **Airspace** | **Forward Flight Visibility** | **Distance from clouds** | **Ground visibility and ceiling** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Control zones | 5KM | Horizontally:<br>600M<br>Vertically:<br>500FT | No aircraft shall take off from, land at, or approach to land at an aerodrome or fly within the control zone when the ground visibility at the aerodrome concerned is less than 5KM and the ceiling is less than 1 500FT. |
| Within an aerodrome traffic zone (which does not also comprise a control zone or part of a control zone) | 5KM | Horizontally:<br>600M<br>Vertically:<br>500FT | No aircraft shall take off from, land at, or approach to land at an aerodrome or fly within the aerodrome traffic zone when the ground visibility within such aerodrome traffic zone is less than 5KM and the ceiling is less than 1 500FT. |

Table 2

In airspaces other than those specified in Table 1

| **Airspace class** | **Altitude Band** | **Forward Flight Visibility** | **Distance from cloud** |
|---|---|---|---|
| C, F, G | At and above 10 000FT above MSL. | 8KM | 1.5KM Horizontally<br>1 000FT Vertically |
| C, F, G | Below 10 000FT AMSL and above 3 000FT above MSL, or above 1 000FT above terrain, whichever is higher. | 5KM | 1.5KM Horizontally<br>1 000FT Vertically |
| C | At and below 3 000FT above MSL, or 1 000FT above terrain, whichever is higher. | 5KM | 1.5KM Horizontally<br>1 000FT Vertically |
| F, G | | 5KM | Clear of cloud and with the surface in sight. |

Provided that the minima specified in Table 1 are not applicable when entering or leaving a CTR and the flight has received clearance from an ATSU to operate under Special VFR minima as referred to in regulation, 91.06.22 -

(i) entering or leaving a CTR and the flight has received clearance from an ATSU to

operate under Special VFR minima as prescribed in regulation 91.06.22; or
(ii) entering or leaving an ATZ on a cross-country flight; and
(iii) a pilot in the aircraft maintains two-way radio communication with the aerodrome control tower or aerodrome flight information service unit, in which case the pilot may leave or enter the aerodrome traffic zone when the ground visibility is equal to or greater than 5KM and the ceiling is equal to or higher than 1 500FT;

b) in the case of helicopters, under conditions of visibility and distance from cloud equal to, or greater than, those conditions specified in Tables 3 and 4:

Table 3

| **Airspace** | **Flight visibility** | **Distance from cloud** | **Ground visibility and ceiling** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Control zones | 5KM | Horizontally:<br>300M<br>Vertically:<br>Clear of cloud | Except when operating under a SVFR clearance no helicopter shall take off from, land at, or approach to land at an aerodrome or fly within the control zone when the ground visibility at the aerodrome concerned is less than 5KM and the ceiling is less than 1 500FT. |
| Within an aerodrome traffic zone (which does not also comprise a control zone or part of a control zone) | 5KM | Horizontally:<br>300M<br>Vertically:<br>Clear of cloud | No helicopter shall take off from, land at, or approach to land at an aerodrome or fly within the aerodrome traffic zone when the ground visibility at the aerodrome concerned is less than 5KM and the ceiling is less than 1 500FT. |

Table 4
In Airspaces other than those specified in Table 3

| **Airspace class** | **Altitude Band** | **Flight Visibility** | **Distance from cloud** |
|---|---|---|---|
| C, F, G | At and above 10 000FT above MSL. | 8KM | 1.5KM Horizontally<br>1 000FT Vertically |
| C, F, G | Below 10 000FT AMSL and above 3 000FT above MSL, or above 1 000FT above terrain, whichever is higher. | 5KM | 1.5KM Horizontally<br>1 000FT Vertically |
| C | At and below 3 000FT above MSL, or 1 000FT above terrain, whichever is higher. | 2.5KM | 1.5KM Horizontally<br>1 000FT Vertically |
| F, G | | 1.5KM unless in accordance with (iii) below | Clear of cloud and with the surface in sight. |

Provided that—
(i) the limitations as contained in Table 3 shall not prevent a helicopter from conducting hover-in-ground-effect or hover-taxi operations within the confines of a controlled aerodrome or heliport, if the visibility is not less than 100M;

(ii) the minima specified in Table 3 are not applicable when a helicopter is entering or leaving a CTR and such flight has received clearance from an ATSU to operate under Special VFR minima as prescribed in regulation 91.06.22; and
(iii) helicopters shall be permitted to operate in less than 1.5KM flight visibility outside of controlled airspace, if manoeuvred at a speed that will give adequate opportunity to observe other traffic or any obstacles in time to avoid collision.

## 2 Special VFR weather minima

A pilot-in-command may conduct special VFR operations in weather conditions below the conditions prescribed in Regulation 91.06.21 within a control zone-

a) under the terms of an air traffic control clearance;
b) by day only;
c) with a cloud ceiling of at least 600FT and visibility of at least 1.5KM, measured from the aerodrome reference point;
d) when the special VFR flight will not delay an IFR flight;
e) in an aircraft equipped with two way radio equipment capable of communicating with an air traffic service unit on the appropriate frequency; and
f) if leaving the control zone, in accordance with instructions issued by an air traffic service unit prior to departure.

A pilot-in-command of a helicopter may only conduct Special VFR operations in weather conditions referred to in Regulation 91.06.21 within a CTR-

a) under the terms of an air traffic control clearance;
b) by day only with a cloud ceiling of at least 300FT and visibility of at least 800M offshore;
c) when clear of clouds;
d) if a helicopter will be operated at such speed that its pilot has adequate opportunity to observe any obstructions or other traffic in sufficient time to avoid collisions;
e) if a flight can be conducted in accordance with regulation 91.06.32 with regards to minimum height; and
f) when a special VFR will not unduly delay an IFR flight.

## 3 VFR flight determination and weather deterioration.

i) The pilot in command of an aircraft operating outside a control zone or an aerodrome traffic zone is responsible to ascertain whether or not weather conditions permit flight in accordance with VFR.

ii) Whenever weather conditions do not permit a pilot to maintain the minimum distance from cloud and the minimum visibility required by VFR, the pilot shall—

a) if in controlled airspace, request an amended clearance enabling the aircraft to continue in VMC to the nearest suitable aerodrome, or to leave the airspace within which an ATC clearance is required;

b) if no clearance in accordance with paragraph (a) can be obtained, continue to operate in VMC and land at the nearest suitable aerodrome, notifying the appropriate ATC unit of the action taken;

c) if operating within a control zone, request authorisation to operate as a special VFR flight; or

d) request clearance to operate in accordance with the IFR.